Janet Swisher

Austin TX / remote | 1-512-657-9291 | janetswisher@fastmail.us |
linkedin.com/in/janetswisher

Principal Technical Writer | Developer Onboarding & Content Strategy

Summary

Principal-level technical writer with 15+ years of experience designing developer onboarding, technical learning experiences, and documentation strategies for complex software platforms. I help developers and enterprise customers move from initial installation to successful implementation through task-focused content, intuitive information architecture, and hands-on validation of product workflows.

I combine technical depth in APIs, SDKs, and enterprise deployment with experience directing cross-functional documentation initiatives, incorporating customer feedback, and improving content with measurable results.

Professional Experience

MTP Consulting | Remote
Senior Technical Writer, Chrome for Developers Social Content
June 2026 – Present

Develop technical content Google's Chrome for Developers social channels, translating web platform capabilities into actional posts for mid- to senior-level web developers. Partner with developer relations, editorial, design, and video teams to ensure technical accuracy and align messaging.

- Helped the team achieve 115% increase in saves/bookmarks and 31% increase in outbound clicks within my first 90 days by deepening technical content and eliminating hype-driven language—recovering engagement despite 50% drop in impressions from algorithmic penalties.

HERE (here.io, formerly OpenFin) | Remote
Lead Technical Writer
Nov 2020 – Feb 2026

Defined and executed documentation strategy for HERE's enterprise browser and SDK platform, enabling financial-services firms to build, integrate, secure, and deploy enterprise applications.

- Designed task-based documentation, information architecture, and learning paths guiding developers, IT administrators, and implementation teams through onboarding, integration, configuration, deployment, and troubleshooting.
- Built API and SDK documentation, getting-started guides, integration tutorials, deployment workflows—validating each hands-on to surface product friction and documentation issues before release.
- Partnered with Product, Engineering, QA, Support, Customer Solutions to prioritize documentation improvements, synthesizing customer feedback, support tickets, and deployment insights to address implementation friction.

- Improved documentation discoverability through task-oriented navigation, content organization, and TypeSense search integration.
- Integrated documentation readiness into product requirements and release criteria. Modernized publishing with a GitHub-based docs-as-code architecture (Docusaurus and GitHub Actions), increasing release-aligned publication from 93% to 100%.
- Established standards, templates, and review workflows that enabled engineers and product managers to contribute and maintain documentation, scaling content production beyond the core writing team.

Mozilla | Remote
MDN Staff Technical Writer
Jan 2020 – Aug 2020

Created developer education for MDN Web Docs covering web platform APIs, CSS, web security, Firefox Developer Tools, and browser capabilities.
- Developed conceptual guides, tutorials, API references, and troubleshooting content that guided developers from learning to implementing new web platform technologies.
- Collaborated with Firefox engineers to validate content and align with browser releases and web platform changes.
- Contributed to MDN Web Docs, which consistently achieved successful-session ratings above 80%, based on users reporting that they found the information they needed.

MDN developer programs & documentation community leadership roles
Mar 2013 – Dec 2019
- Coordinated global staff and volunteer contributors to expand and maintain MDN's developer documentation coverage, establishing workflows and standards that sustained consistency across distributed teams.
- Mentored contributors, providing technical and editorial feedback to align content with editorial standards.
- Facilitated Large Scale Scrum (LeSS) processes across distributed documentation and development teams.

MDN Technical Writer/Community Steward
Jun 2010 – Feb 2013

- Authored, reviewed, and edited documentation covering HTML, CSS, JavaScript, web platform APIs, and standards-based application development.
- Supported documentation contribution workflows for a global developer community.

Lombardi (IBM acquisition) | Austin, Texas
Senior Information Developer
2009 – 2010

- Produced enterprise software documentation covering architecture, configuration, and deployment using DITA single-sourcing for web, PDF, and in-product help.
- Developed a metadata-driven proof-of-concept implementation for reusable, proposal content, integrating workflows with the Lombardi's BPM platform to reduce proposal assembly time.

Enthought, Inc. | Austin, Texas
Senior Technical Writer
2004 – 2009

- Documented Python-based scientific libraries and custom applications (SciPy, NumPy, and Enthought Python Distribution) and developed Python tooling for cross-platform, context-sensitive application help.

Skills

- **Developer onboarding and education:** Getting-started guides, task-based tutorials, learning paths, API and SDK documentation, integration, configuration and deployment workflows, troubleshooting, conceptual guides
- **Content strategy and architecture:** Information architecture, navigation design, search and discoverability, content governance, contributor enablement
- **Development technologies:** Browser APIs, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, web security, developer tools, Python libraries, OpenAPI, YAML, JSON
- **Documentation technologies:** Docs-as-code, Git, GitHub, GitLab, GitHub Actions, Docusaurus, Markdown, reStructuredText, TypeSense, Confluence, DITA XML
- **Technical collaboration:** Hands-on workflow testing, cross-functional planning, customer implementation insights, release coordination
- **AI-assisted content**: LLM-assisted drafting, editing, content adaptation, source validation, technical review
- **Methodologies:** Agile, Large Scale Scrum (LeSS), distributed team collaboration

Education and Certification

- Certified LeSS Practitioner® — The LeSS Company B.V., 2018
- Technical coursework — University of Texas at Austin and Austin Community College: Data Structures, Analysis of Programs, Java Programming
- University of Chicago — B.A. in Humanities